



Day 3 Task — Digital Evidence Handling & Chain of Custody



Trios cyber • 4 Sept (Edited 6 Sept)

100/100 | Due 5 Sept

Practical Assignment: Digital Evidence Handling & Chain of Custody

Dear Students,

For this practical assignment, you are required to prepare and document the proper handling of a digital evidence item from initial identification through preservation and transfer.

The objective of this exercise is to understand how digital evidence should be identified, documented, preserved and tracked throughout an investigation.

Part 1: Identify the Evidence

Consider a computer, laptop, external drive, USB drive, or other digital storage device as the evidence item. You can choose your own evidence.

Document the following information:

- Evidence ID
- Evidence type
- Device/source description
- Make/model, where available
- Serial number, where available
- Date and time of identification
- Location of the evidence
- Initial condition/state
- Person identifying/collecting the evidence

Part 2: Initial Evidence Assessment

Document the condition of the evidence before any examination.

Consider:

- Is the device powered on or powered off?
- Are any external devices connected?
- Are there visible identifiers or labels?
- What storage media are present?



- What immediate actions should be avoided to prevent alteration of evidence?

Briefly explain why documenting the initial condition is important.

Part 3: Order of Volatility

Prepare an order of volatility for the following evidence:

- Live system state
- Running processes
- Persistent storage
- Preserved forensic image

Arrange them from most volatile to least volatile and explain why volatile information may need to be collected before less volatile evidence.

Part 4: Evidence Preservation

Describe the steps that should be taken to preserve the evidence before examination.

Include:

- Protecting the original evidence
- Preventing unnecessary modification
- Appropriate isolation
- Maintaining the evidence identifier
- Using a forensic copy for examination
- Recording preservation actions

Part 5: Chain of Custody

Prepare a chain-of-custody record for your selected evidence item.

Your record should include:

- Evidence ID
- Date and time
- Released by
- Received by
- Purpose of transfer
- Storage/handling information
- Signatures/names, where applicable

Create at least two example entries showing the transfer of the evidence from one person/location to another.

Part 6: Document Your Work

Prepare a PDF or DOCX report documenting the complete procedure.

Your report must include:



1. Student Information

- Name
- Course/Subject
- Assignment Title
- Date

2. Evidence Information

- Evidence ID
- Evidence type
- Description
- Initial condition

3. Order of Volatility

Provide the ordered list and explanation.

4. Preservation Procedure

Explain how the evidence should be protected and maintained.

5. Chain of Custody

Include your completed chain-of-custody record.

6. Screenshots/Supporting Material

Include appropriate screenshots, photographs, diagrams or tables where applicable.

7. Result

Summarize how the evidence was identified, preserved and tracked.

Submission Requirements

Submit ONE file only:

- PDF (.pdf) OR
- Microsoft Word document (.docx)

Important Notes

Use only fictional, classroom or authorized evidence information for this exercise. Do not include another person's private or confidential information.

The purpose of this task is to understand proper evidence handling and documentation, not to perform an actual investigation.

Expected Learning Outcome



After completing this practical, you should be able to:

1. Identify and document a digital evidence source.
2. Explain the order of volatility.
3. Describe appropriate evidence preservation procedures.
4. Prepare a basic chain-of-custody record.
5. Understand the importance of maintaining evidence continuity.

Submission: Upload your completed PDF/DOCX report to this Google Classroom assignment before the specified deadline. Late submissions are accepted but marks will be deducted.

Please read the instructions carefully before beginning the practical.

Your work

Marked

Chain-of-Custody-Form.docx - Google Docs.pdf
PDF



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